

Live BPM Analyzer

Reads the real tempo of a finished song from the audio itself, to two decimal places — and sets the project tempo to it without shifting anything you have already placed.

Use the shortcut you assigned during install — or run it from [Actions](#) → [Show Action List](#)

WHAT IT IS FOR

Your grid has to sit on the track, or every cue you place drifts. The tempo printed on a release, or reported by a DJ tool, is usually rounded to a whole number — and a TV edit is often time-compressed by a fraction of a percent on top of that. Half a BPM out over three minutes is several beats of drift by the end.

This reads the tempo out of the waveform and gives you the actual figure.

STEP BY STEP

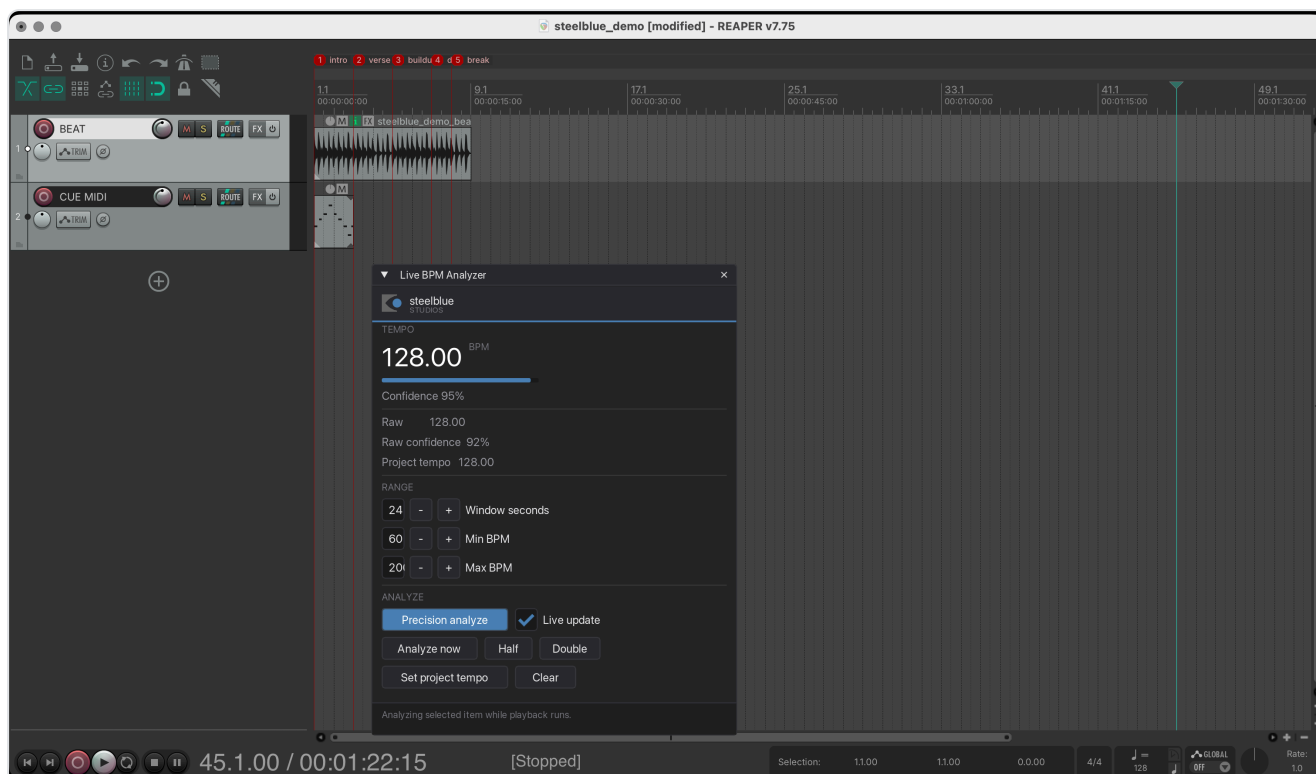
- 1 Select the song item**

Click the audio item in the arrange view. If nothing is selected, the plugin looks for the item under the play cursor.

2

Start the plugin

Run **Live BPM Analyzer** — with the shortcut you assigned, or from the Action List. It starts reading immediately, updating as playback runs.



Reading a song at 128 BPM. The bar under the number is the confidence.

3

Press Precision analyze for the real answer

Live mode looks at a short rolling window and is meant for a quick glance while the track plays. **Precision analyze** takes up to two minutes of audio out of the middle of the song — skipping intro and outro, where the beat is least reliable — and measures across it.

Live updating switches itself off afterwards, so the result stays on screen instead of being overwritten a moment later.

4

Set project tempo

This is safe to press on a project you have already worked in: every item's position, length and playrate is preserved. Nothing gets stretched or dragged along by the tempo change.

READING THE NUMBERS

Confidence

Confidence answers "how sure am I about *this number*", not "is there music playing". It rewards a clear, steady pulse that stays put over minutes. Roughly:

Above 70 % A solid, steady beat. Trust the figure.

40–70 % Usable, but check it against the grid before you build on it.

Under 30 % There is no reliable pulse here — a rubato passage, an ambient bed, or a section with no drums. The number is a guess.

A produced track with vocals and pads typically lands around 80 %; a bare drum loop goes over 90 %. Noise and free-tempo material sit under 10 %, which is the point of the scale.

Half and Double

Every piece of music is equally "correct" at half and at double its tempo — 65 and 130 describe the same grid, just counted differently. The analyzer picks the musically likely reading, but for half-time material it may land an octave off. **Half** and **Double** are there to correct that in one click, and they keep every decimal place.

When a half or double reading is genuinely almost as strong, a line appears under the status telling you so. If that line stays away, the reading is unambiguous.

Raw versus displayed

The big figure is smoothed over the last few measurements; **Raw** is the latest one on its own. When the two drift apart while a track plays, the tempo itself is moving — a live recording, or a hand-played edit.

GOOD TO KNOW

Window seconds, Min and Max BPM

Leave these alone unless you have a reason. Narrowing Min/Max around a tempo you already suspect helps on difficult material — set 120 to 140 if you know it is house-ish, and the octave question disappears by itself.

What "130" on the label usually means

It usually means "about 130". If your grid drifts on a track that is supposedly a round number, measure it: released material sitting at 130.97 rather than 130.00 is entirely normal, and that difference is worth about seven beats of drift over three minutes.